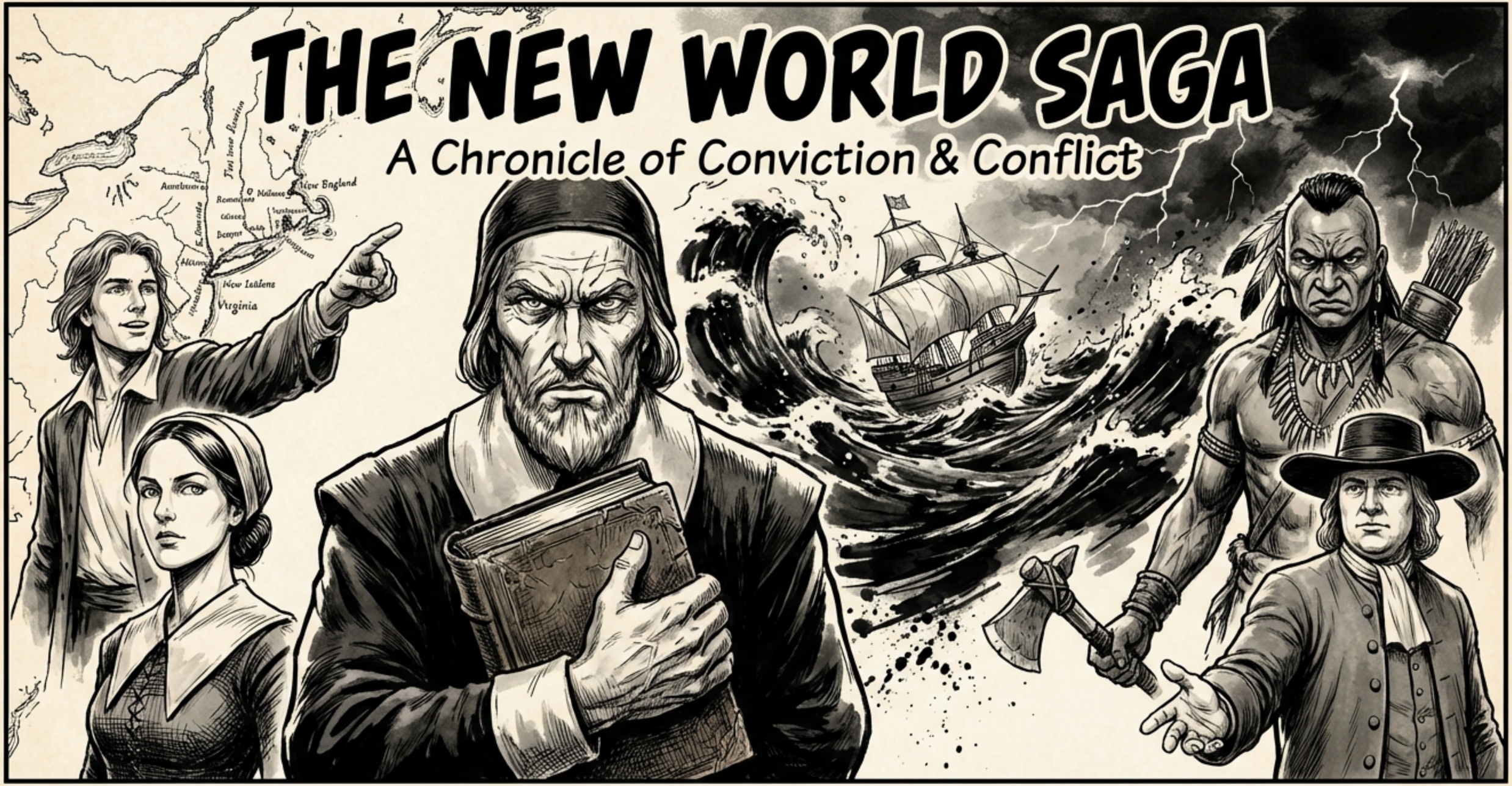

The Founding of the American Colonies

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Chapter 1: A King's Wrath, A Pilgrim's Vow

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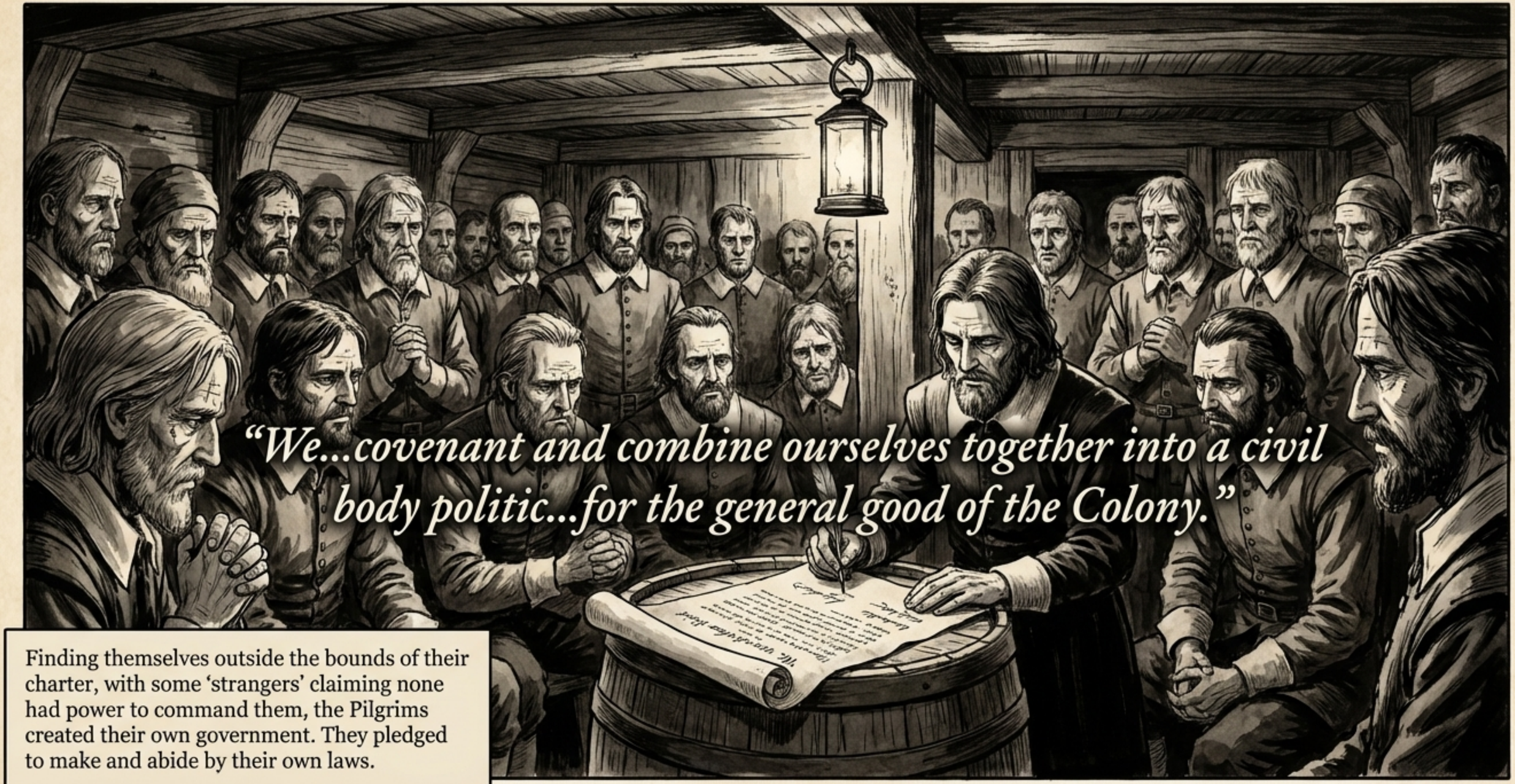
Chapter 2: The Covenant



Finding themselves outside the bounds of their charter, with some ‘strangers’ claiming none had power to command them, the Pilgrims created their own government. They pledged to make and abide by their own laws.

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Chapter 3: The City Upon a Hill

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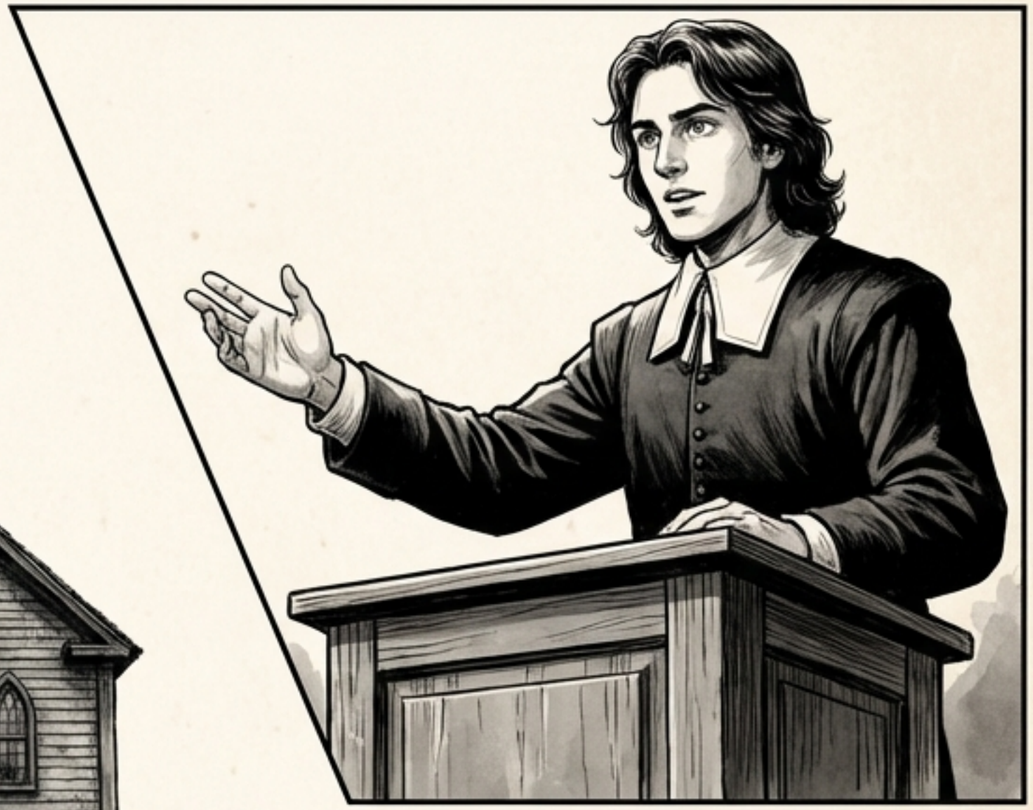
Chapter 4: Cracks in the Citadel



The Puritan leaders did not tolerate questions about their religious beliefs or the way the colony was governed. Discontented colonists were often forced to leave.

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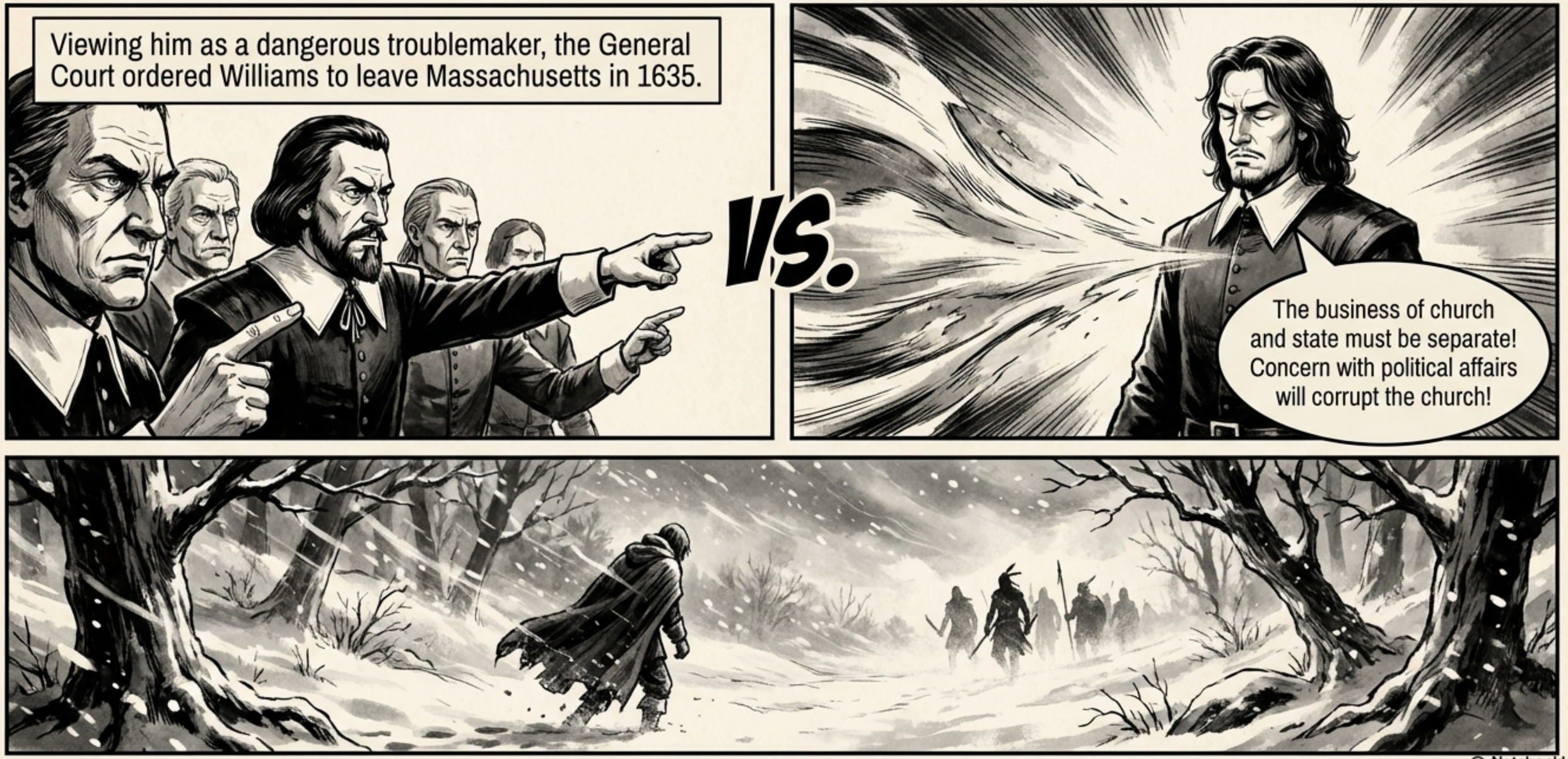
Chapter 5: The Banished Soul



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Chapter 6: The Trial of a Heretic

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Chapter 7: Sanctuaries of Freedom

The Fundamental Orders gave the vote to all male property owners, even non-church members, and limited the governor's power, expanding representative government.

Rhode Island allowed complete freedom of religion, with no state church. It became a haven for those who disliked the strict Puritan rule.

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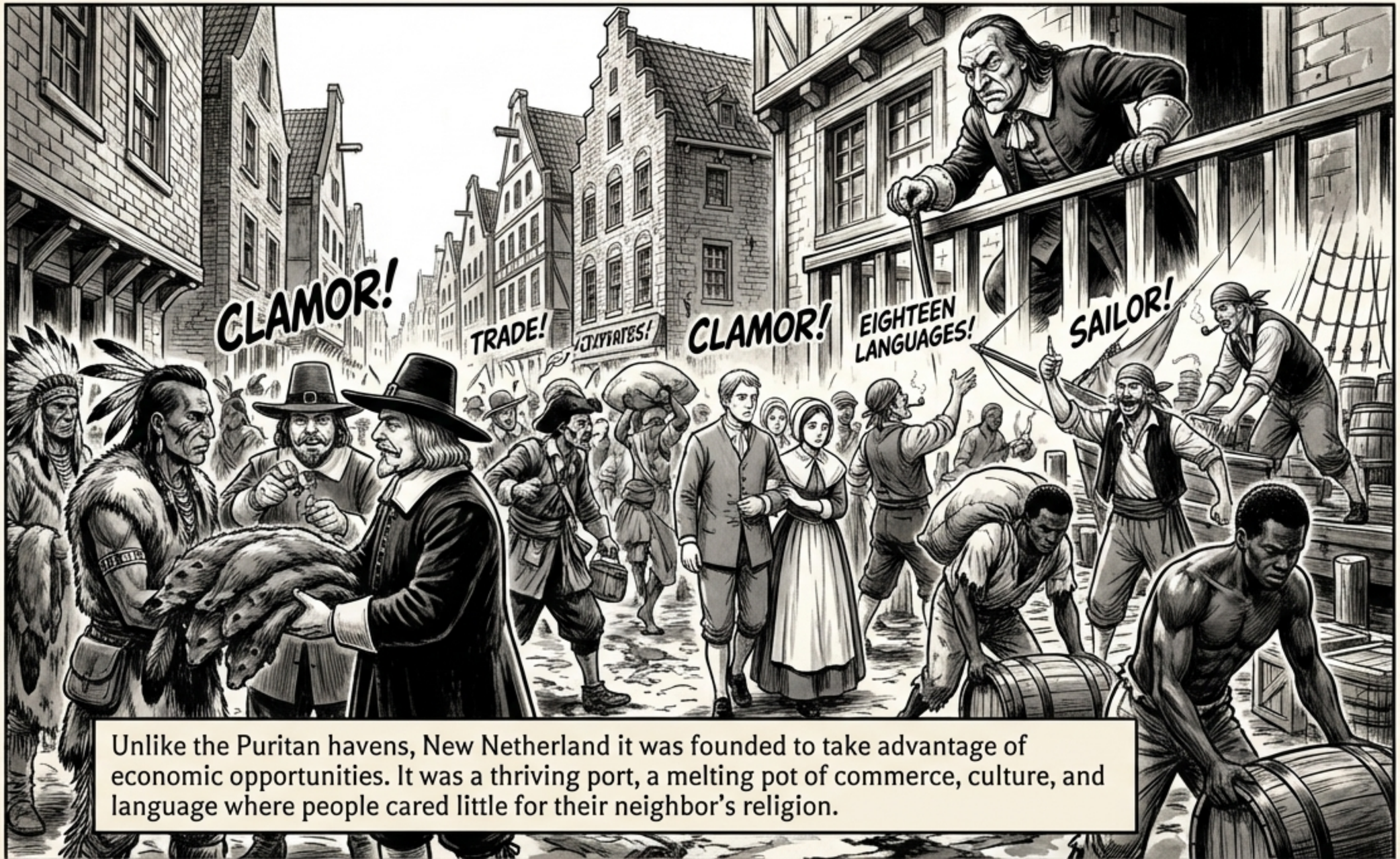
Chapter 8: The Port of Profit



Unlike the Puritan havens, New Netherland it was founded to take advantage of economic opportunities. It was a thriving port, a melting pot of commerce, culture, and language where people cared little for their neighbor's religion.

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Chapter 9: The English Lion Arrives

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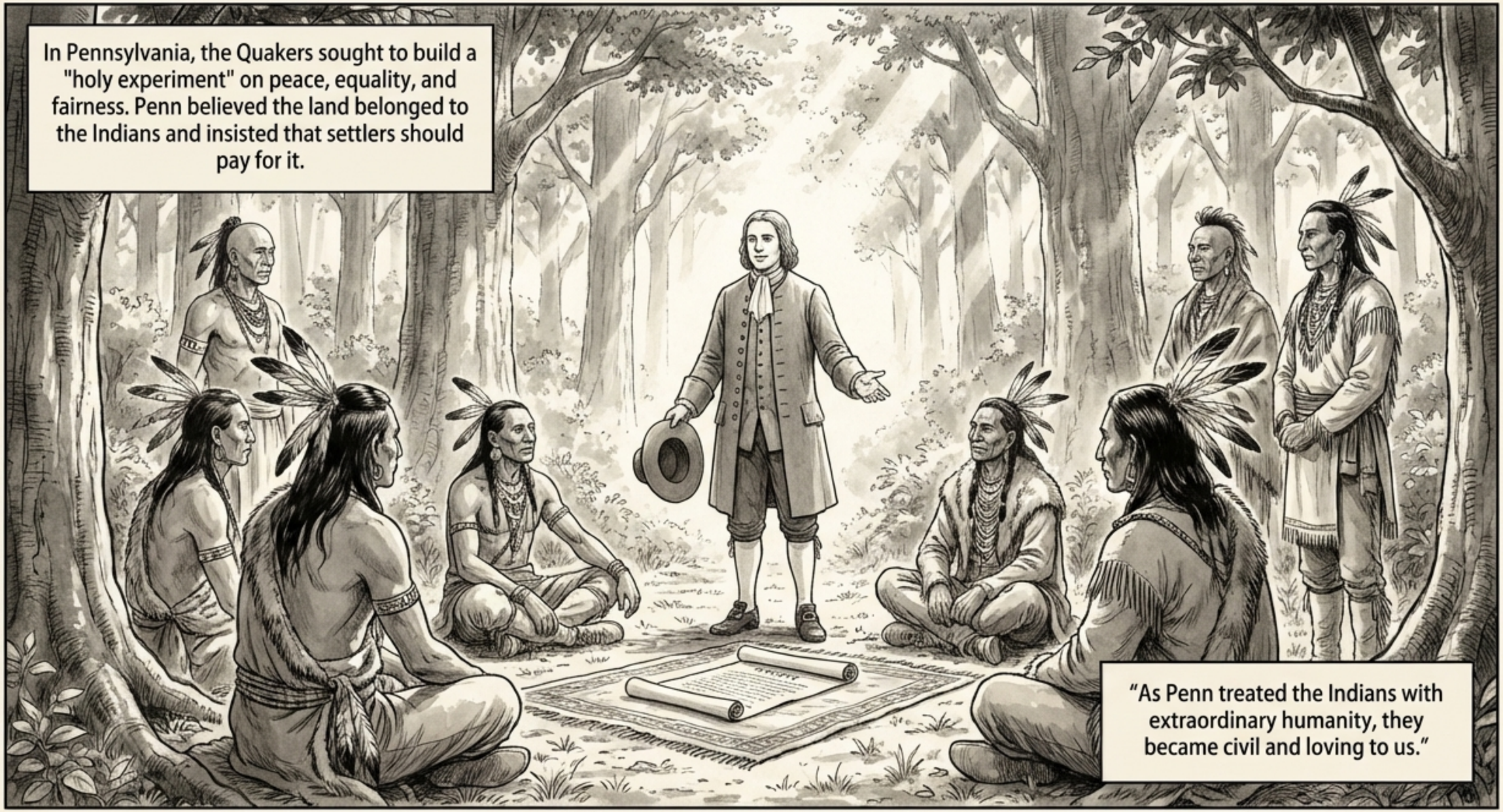
Chapter 10: The Pacifist's Quest



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Chapter 11: The Tidewater Kingdom

The Southern Colonies' wealth was built on cash crops like tobacco and rice. This plantation system was fueled by the headright system—land grants for bringing over workers—which led to the expansion of slavery across the South.

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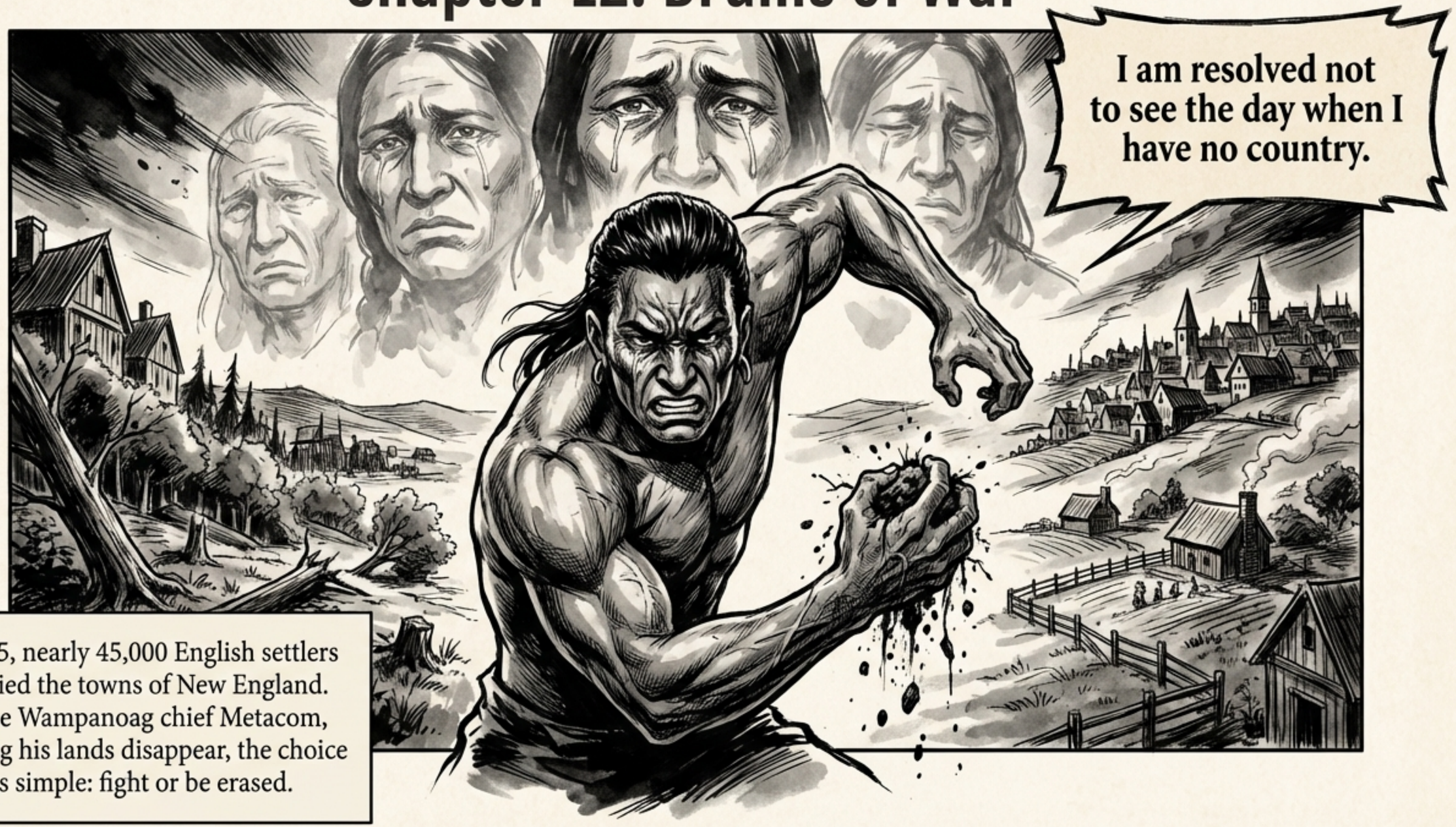
Chapter 12: Drums of War



By 1675, nearly 45,000 English settlers occupied the towns of New England. For the Wampanoag chief Metacom, watching his lands disappear, the choice was simple: fight or be erased.

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Chapter 13: New England in Flames

The war ended in devastating defeat. With Metacom killed and his people captured, over a thousand survivors—including his own family—were sold into slavery in the West Indies, their homeland lost forever.

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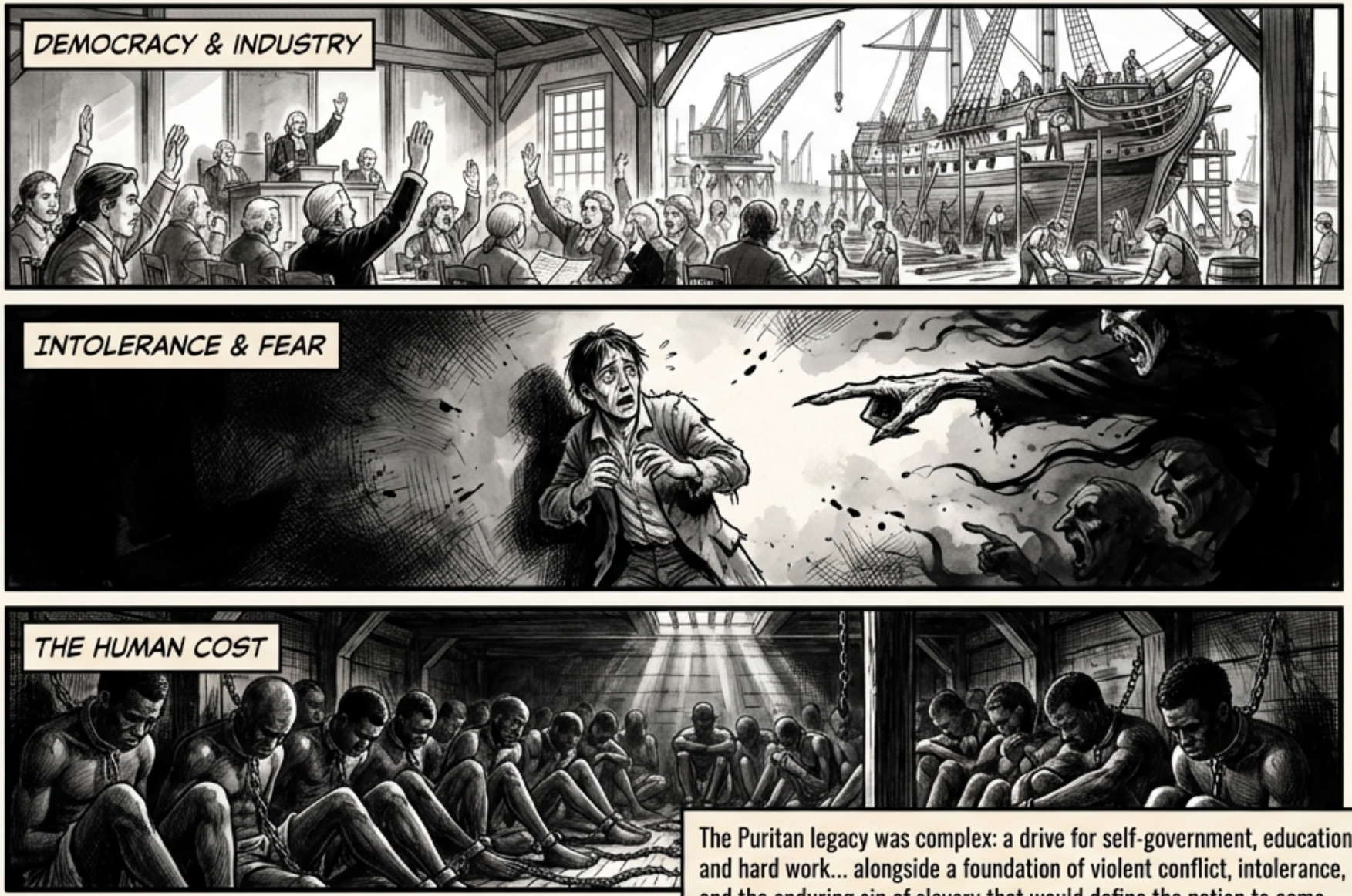
Chapter 14: An Inheritance of Contradictions



The Puritan legacy was complex: a drive for self-government, education, and hard work... alongside a foundation of violent conflict, intolerance, and the enduring sin of slavery that would define the nation to come.

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